

"THE CHALLENGE REALLY IS HAVING YOUR OWN IDENTITY WITHIN THE ORGANISATION WHILST ELDERS ARE STILL THERE"

ANJALI SINGH
EXECUTIVE CHAIRPERSON, ANAND GROUP

- **Leads a $2.2-billion automotive conglomerate comprising 23 companies across 85-plus locations**
- **Spearheaded diversification across group companies into future mobility areas**
- **Launched ANEVOLVE, a forward-looking platform focused on green technologies and future-tech mobility solutions underlying the group's commitment to sustainability and future-ready innovation**
- **Co-Founder and Creative Director of SUJÁN, a conservation-led luxury hospitality brand**

PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

form focused on green technologies and future mobility solutions.

Singh served as Chairperson of the ACMA Western Region and of CII Northern Region for 2025-26, roles that come with their own set of challenges. "Some of these associations are still very male dominated. It takes a little bit of your skills of positioning yourselves to hold your own among some stalwarts of the industry," she says.

Sometimes it is simply about people being uncomfortable with a woman being present in a male-dominated environment. "Often at industry body dinners or events, I find myself the only woman in the room, and the men struggling to make conversation with me," says Gauri Kirloskar. "I call these minor inconveniences, but I have not faced too many challenges myself."

Things changed a bit post liberalisation with a new generation of entrepreneurs setting up business in areas like healthcare and consumer goods. These are also areas where women have traditionally found some representation, even if not at the top, making acceptance a bit easier. "Women have always played an important role in building and strengthening healthcare organisations and have for decades been strongly represented among clinicians, laboratory professionals and across many other functions," says Alisha Moopen, Managing Director and Group CEO, Aster DM Healthcare.

For her, the challenge wasn't so much around gender but being a young leader in the workplace. "One thing I learnt quite early is that you cannot spend too much energy